MUSIC

# AMPED UP AND UNPLUGGED

**THE MAHINDRA INDEPENDENCE ROCK FESTIVAL PROMISES AN INTERESTING LINE-UP OF OLD AND NEW ACTS, CEMENTING ITS REPUTATION AS THE 'WOODSTOCK OF INDIA'**









*Clockwise from right, Indus Creed, Swarathma, Girish and The Chronicles, and 13AD*

PRABL DEEP DAS

The 30th season of the Mahindra Independence Rock Festival is all set to take place this weekend in Mumbai. This year, the country's oldest rock festival promises a unique line-up, reuniting the legends and unleashing young blood—presenting a mixed bag of nostalgia, homecoming, reunions and new voices emerging from all over the country. "The 'Dirty 30' is the unabashed and unapologetic edition, which will be louder than ever, etching its name in India's Rock Hall of Fame," says Farhad Wadia, founder, Independence Rock.

After almost a decade, one of India's most influential ethnic progressive rock bands will make a comeback on the I-Rock stage. Kerala-based Motherjane will return with an amalgamation of progressive rock and Carnatic music. The coming together of Kochi-based 13AD after 28 years is another highlight that hard rock fans can look forward to. Its set list will blend their most beloved songs with some new material. "It will be a celebration connecting the past and the present using enhanced stage visuals and current technology," says George Peter from 13AD. Nagaland-based experimental rock band About Us is poised for a national breakthrough at I-Rock this year.

Further, New Delhi-based international chart-topping band Bloodywood aims to enchant while breaking into riffs. Bombay Metal Project will create an animated heavy metal experience. Indus Creed will invoke the nostalgia of rock's golden era. Bengaluru-based folk-rock band Swarathma will perform with an eclectic ensemble, including Parvaaz, Sidd Coutto, Bhayanak Maut and Sutej. Chennai-based band Skrat will take audiences on a journey of spectacular storytelling. Sikkim-based Girish and The Chronicles will transport the crowd back to the 1980s and perform their new single at the festival this year. "We're also planning to bring back some hidden gems from our first album—songs our fans don't usually get to hear live," says Girish Pradhan, the band's vocalist.

**The festival is taking place from Nov. 16–17 at Bayview Lawns (Princess Dock, Mazagon), Mumbai**